

MELISSA CUNNINGHAM



dishes for family and friends.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Melissa Cunningham is a results-driven professional with over a decade of expertise in program and project management, operational excellence, and strategic problem-solving across diverse industries. As a Senior Program Manager with Sand Cherry Associates, she collaborates with a leading satellite and terrestrial network operator to execute high-impact programs that enhance global connectivity and operational performance.

In her most recent role, Melissa spearheaded a comprehensive "get well" program for an underperforming business unit grappling with technical and operational challenges. Her work involved fortifying core networks, implementing new processes, and driving organizational change to recover lost revenue and regain customer trust. This role required a blend of thought leadership, problem solving across a highly matrixed organization and influential leadership to operationalize solutions that meet rapidly evolving market demands.

Melissa's career is underpinned by a robust skill set encompassing program governance, risk management, vendor oversight, cross-functional leadership, and process optimization. Her ability to tackle multifaceted challenges ensures the delivery of exceptional outcomes for stakeholders and customers alike.

Prior to her role at Sand Cherry Associates, Melissa held senior project management positions at Deloitte Consulting, SAP America, QVC, and Amtrak. In these roles, she consistently delivered multimillion-dollar projects, leveraging her expertise to implement transformative solutions, streamline operations, and driving impactful business improvements.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

• Program Management

- Provided leadership in change management, stakeholder engagement, vendor oversight, and program governance to successfully execute of large-scale initiatives.
- Directed multi-million-dollar full lifecycle implementations for the largest rail transportation company in the U.S
- Developed integrated plans and budgets, coordinated efforts of technology and engineering teams (internal and external vendors), and facilitated requirements gathering, workflow design, and operational readiness.

Vendor Management:

- Ensured vendor performance through scorecards focused on time, quality, and compliance with project goal.

• Platform Delivery:

- Delivered a multi-million dollar cloud-based technology platform for one of the largest online retailers, enabling enhanced product lifecycle management capabilities.

• Data Transformation:

- Led a critical data-delivery initiative, accessing disparate data sources, updating business logic, and implementing integrity checks to provide actionable, recurring insights for employee adoption and strategic use.

• Process Improvement:

- Spearheaded global process and ERP system redesigns, enhancing sales operations and supply chain workflows.
- Engaged stakeholders across countries and business units, working with SMEs to manage interdependencies and align goals.
- Planned and facilitated workshops involving executive, managerial, and technical teams to drive process optimization.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- University of Massachusetts, BA in Communications
- Scrum Master Certification (SMC), Scrum Study, 2021
- Yellow Belt, Scrum Study, 2021